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Value Stream Handoff Guide

Use this guide when you need to describe an **end-to-end flow of value** that crosses capabilities, teams, or bounded contexts.

This guide is about **how value is delivered from trigger to outcome**.

KNOWLEDGE AREA

This guide helps with **how value flows from trigger to outcome**. Technically, it covers **end-to-end value delivery flow**.

Guide family map

Where this guide sits in the full Blueprint Handoff Atlas family.

ROOT & CROSS-CUTTING

Handoff Atlas

Blueprint Bundle

Metamodel Vocabulary

Migrations

DESIGN

Architecture

Concepts

Domain

Dynamics

Infrastructure

Interactions

Models

Quality

Rules

Story

GOVERNANCE

Capability

Decisions

Motivation

Organization

Roadmap

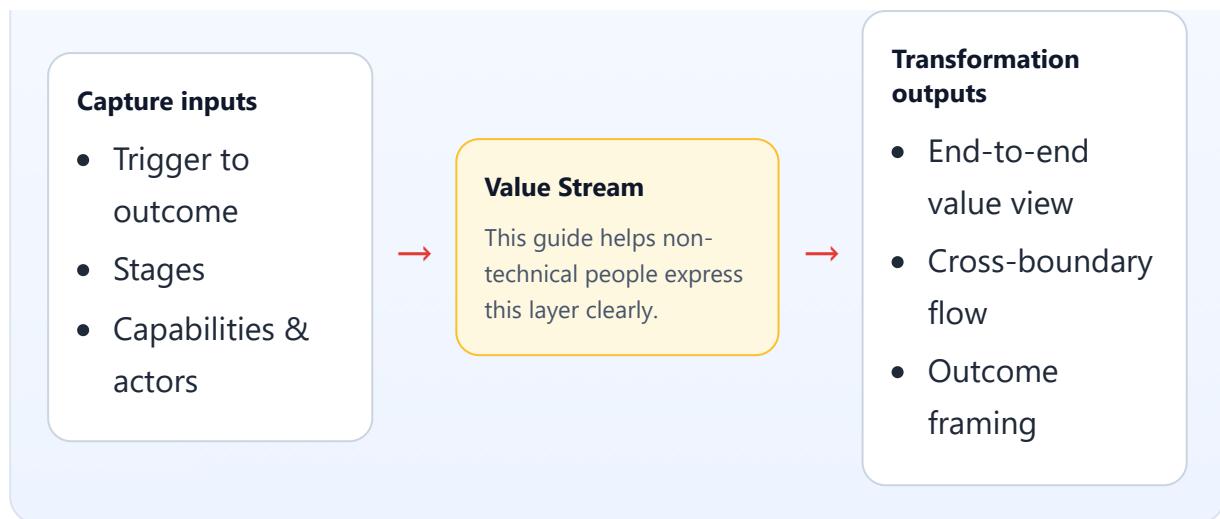
Leverage

Test Cases

Value Stream

Capture → focus → transformation

What to gather first, what this layer focuses on, and what a modeler or AI agent can produce from it.



Main entities in this guide

- **Value Stream** — an end-to-end flow that turns a trigger into value for someone.
- **Stage** — one major phase inside that value stream.
 - Often confused with: a capability or a story. A value stream spans end-to-end value delivery; a story is one scenario, and a capability is a stable ability.

What belongs here

- end-to-end value streams
- triggers and outcomes
- ordered stages of value creation
- primary actors
- related capabilities and end-to-end measures

What does not belong here

- a low-level step-by-step process inside one team only
- a capability map with no flow
- isolated milestones with no value journey

Core things to capture

- what value stream exists
- what triggers it
- what outcome it delivers
- what stages it passes through

- who benefits or participates
- what capabilities support each stage

Core relationships to capture

- value stream -> stage
- stage -> capability
- stream -> primary actor
- stream -> trigger and outcome
- stream -> end-to-end measure or goal

Modus operandi

Describe value from outside-in:

1. identify the trigger
2. identify the final value delivered
3. split the journey into stages
4. identify actors and capabilities involved
5. note end-to-end success measures

Prompt set

- what starts the value stream?
- what final value is delivered, and to whom?
- what stages happen in between?
- what capabilities enable each stage?
- what end-to-end measures matter?

Free-text intake template

- **Value stream name:**
- **Trigger:**
- **Outcome/value delivered:**
- **Primary actors:**
- **Stages:**
 - stage:
 - purpose:
 - supported capabilities:
- **Measures/goals:**

Worked example

- Value stream: product return fulfillment
- Trigger: customer wants to return an item
- Outcome: approved return is recorded and refund processing is initiated
- Stages: request, eligibility check, decision, shipment, refund

Layer-specific handoff guidance

For value streams, the handoff should preserve the **end-to-end value journey**.

The receiver should be able to tell:

- what triggers the stream
- what final value is delivered
- what stages happen in between
- what actors and capabilities support the journey

If the description has stages but no trigger or final outcome, the handoff is missing its frame.

How this becomes YAML

A technical modeler or AI agent can transform this into value stream entries with ordered stages, actors, capability links, and outcome framing.

Common mistakes

- confusing a capability with a value stream
- skipping the trigger or final outcome
- making stages too technical
- omitting the capabilities that support the stream